



cost Rs 14 crore and Rs 11 crore, respectively. Interestingly, if a team retains a fourth player, the cost reverts to Rs 18 crore, with Rs 14 crore for a fifth player. Each uncapped Indian player retained costs Rs 4 crore.

"Retention calls aren't easy," admitted a franchise insider with extensive experience in the process. "With multiple layers of purse

deduction, a lot of strategy is involved. **It's not just about retaining a player; it's also about calculating whether you can bring him back through the auction.** It's a lot of mathematics," the veteran strategist explained.

Past examples, such as the Delhi Capitals' experience with former captain Shreyas, underscore the importance of clear planning in

Levelling the playing field: Delhi Capitals co-owner Parth Jindal has expressed strong support for mega auctions. He feels it makes the IPL more competitive. THE HINDU PHOTO LIBRARY

retention and auctions. Until 2021, Shreyas captained Delhi Capitals, but the franchise eventually let him go ahead of the mega auction three years ago. The team struggled after his departure, which contributed to the dismissal of former head coach Ponting.

As industry experts reiterate, planning and clear vision are critical to retention and auction decisions. Over the IPL's 16-year history, franchises have tested various approaches, ultimately learning that no one strategy suits all. As Jindal emphasised, "To each his own."

« This year, the BCCI revised the retention rules to adjust for a purse of Rs 120 crore, a 20 per cent increase from last year »